

Open-Ended Question Examples



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Coach: What expectations do you have for your first show?

Client: I'd like to do this show I found in eight weeks and win my class.

Coach: Eight weeks is a fairly short competition prep. Why did you choose that timeline in particular?

Client: Well, a lot of people at my gym say I only need 8 to 12 weeks to prep and I feel like I'm pretty lean.

Coach: I'd agree that you have a great base and a lot of potential! But, that timeline is really short for a competition prep. In order to be competitive enough, you're going to have to get leaner than you think and that timeline doesn't really allow for that, or to properly peak you into the show.

Client: I heard that peak week I'll take diuretics and then I'll drop at least five pounds.

Coach: Some competitors do use diuretics, but I wouldn't suggest that. We can discuss that more at the end of the consult. But in terms of the length of prep, let's adjust that timeline a bit. You said you want to be competitive and win your class, correct?

Client: Yes!

Coach: While there are no guarantees with placings, my job is to put you in the space to be as competitive as possible. Putting you on stage after an eight-week prep wouldn't align with that goal.

Client: That makes more sense, and while I know placings are never guaranteed, I definitely do want to be as competitive as possible! Even if that means a longer competition prep.

Coach: Great! Let's talk through a longer timeline and what that would look like for your season. Tell me about your first competition prep experience. What methods did you use during that time?

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Client: I'm not sure if this is normal but it all felt pretty extreme. I was doing 90 minutes of cardio every day for 16 weeks; my diet didn't change during that time either. It was so restrictive. And even though I didn't take them, my coach suggested that I use steroids.

Coach: Sorry to hear you had such a tough time your last prep! While competition prep will always be challenging, those are not the only methods you can use to get lean. They will get you lean fast, but they're not the approach I'd recommend.

Client: I'm glad you said that because while I did get really lean, I don't think I want to do that again.

Coach: How would you feel about taking several months to build together before we entered a competition prep, so you would be in the best starting position to prep, and then take a slower approach this time?

Client: That sounds great! Does this mean I won't have to use steroids this prep? That's something that I was worried about.

Coach: You certainly don't need to use any performance enhancers to compete if you don't want to. There are entire federations that are natural, and there are many competitors who never use any steroids during their competition preps. I would never push you to take something you were uncomfortable with or not fully informed about.

Client: Okay, that makes me feel a lot better!

Coach: I'm happy to hear that! Let's start to put a tentative timeline for this offseason together now.